



WhatsApp Pay coming this year

Reportedly, WhatsApp Pay, a payments system, is coming to all WhatsApp users in India this year. <https://digit.in/aug19-71>



Bye Bye Butterfly

Apple may finally be moving on from the butterfly keyboard to introduce a new scissor-switch design. <https://digit.in/aug19-72>

Samsung Galaxy Tab S5e

A worthy contender to the iPad Air?

If you are looking for the best tablet that money can buy, chances are you are looking at an iPad. However, if you are not interested in getting locked into a closed eco-system, then you might want to consider taking a look at the Samsung Galaxy Tab S5e. The tablet is priced at Rs 39,999 for the 4GB RAM and 64GB storage variant with support for LTE, which we have here for review. How does the Tab S5e perform? Read on and find out.

Display and audio

Calling the Tab S5e's display fantastic would be an understatement. We consumed a lot of content from Netflix, YouTube and Prime Videos and most of it looked outstanding. Colours look vibrant and fantastic. But on Netflix, we were left wanting more. We tried using the display under direct sunlight and it works quite well.

Coming to the audio, the Galaxy Tab S5e trumps the iPad Air (2019) easily. It has 4 speakers, both firing in the same direction. So with the Galaxy Tab S5e, we have better channel separation which is quite easily noticeable. Overall, the audio is clean, dialogues are clear and the speakers are loud enough.

Performance

When it comes to everyday performance, like checking mail, browsing the Internet, watching videos, etc., the tablet performed impressively without any stutters. The only underwhelming experience is typing on the touch screen. When it comes to gaming too, the tablet will run any game you throw at it with ease. If you are one that will use the camera, then know that it won't replace your smartphone camera. But for video



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PERFORMANCE.....	69
DESIGN.....	82
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calls, it can get the job done well. No worries.

You can switch between DeX and normal tablet mode with the tap of a button in the drop-down notification window. When in DeX mode, you get a

desktop like an experience which works well, but isn't perfect. Even though you can use your finger for tasks like moving windows around, resizing windows, etc. you will miss a mouse.

Build and design

Slim, elegant and well-built are the first things that will come to mind when you see the Galaxy Tab S5e. The tablet doesn't have an all-glass back like its sibling, the Galaxy Tab S4 and we personally like that. The back has a gunmetal coloured finish very reminiscent of the iPad. The 10.5-inch form factor is a tried-and-tested one so as far as ergonomics are concerned, you will feel right at home. When playing games or watching videos, the device is comfortable to use.

Unlike the iPad Air, the galaxy tab S5e forgoes the headphones jack which we personally miss. There is one ergonomic qualm we have with the

device - the placement of the fingerprint sensor. This placement is just like we've seen on the Galaxy S10e and while it is ergonomic on a phone, it isn't so on the tablet. Reaching for it feels a little out of place. Overall, the build of the tablet is good and premium.

Battery

The Samsung Galaxy Tab S5e has a 7040mAh battery - in line with what we saw on the Galaxy Tab S4. In our battery benchmark with the display on full brightness, the tablet died in a little over 6 hours. However, in real-world usage, it can last much longer. Playback from streaming services saw a drop of about 13 per cent in one hour based on the streaming service. Local playback saw about 8 per cent drop per hour. Keeping the brightness on auto, and you have a device that can last about 10 to 12 hours of content consumption with ease. The battery life will vary based on usage and some productivity scenarios may see it drain faster.

Samsung Galaxy Tab S5e Verdict

Look at it this way, it is cheaper than the iPad and offers near par performance as far as basic everyday work is concerned including content consumption, gaming, social media and some productivity. But the Snapdragon 670 is nowhere near as powerful as the A12 on the iPad Air. You can run some intense photo editing and Augmented Reality apps on the iPad which will bring the Galaxy Tab S5e to its knees. If you are looking for a tablet to replace your laptop for basic work and entertainment or are looking to get a device with good battery life for use on the go, then yes you can consider the Samsung Galaxy Tab S5e. For the professional using dedicated apps like Photoshop, the iPad Air is a better choice if the iPad Pro is out of your budget.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 10.50-inch (1600x2560) | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 670 | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP | RAM: 4GB | OS: Android 9.0 | STORAGE: 64GB | REAR CAMERA: 13MP | BATTERY CAPACITY: 7,040mAh

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